

Resolving arguments

Listening is key to resolving arguments. To settle a dispute, everyone needs to air their views and have space to reflect on both what others have said and what they hope to achieve. This can be done through empathy, negotiation, and compromise. If a dispute continues, it's time to accept that different opinions need to be respected even if they are not agreed with.

1. Empathizing

Empathy is the ability to understand how somebody else might feel—to see things from somebody else's point of view. To consider how an action might upset someone can help you see their side. If, by empathizing, you realize that you've made a mistake or misunderstood, don't be afraid to say so.



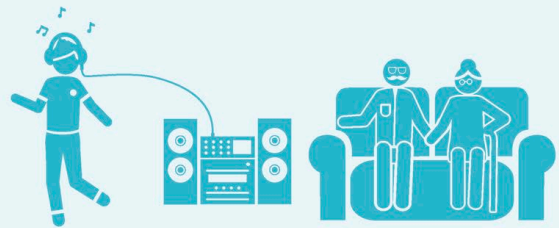
2. Negotiating

Make clear what it is you are hoping to achieve, but always listen to the other side and let them finish talking. Making eye contact will show the person that you are interested in what they are saying. Clarify anything that you do not understand, and set the goal of trying to agree on one or two points.



3. Compromising

To achieve a resolution, both sides need to make concessions to allow everyone to achieve something. Listening and being open to changing your mind is a good skill to have. It will help you navigate relationships with others even when there are difficult issues to resolve.



“Holding onto anger is like grasping a **hot coal** with the intent of throwing it at someone else: you are the one who gets **burned**.”

The Buddha

Saying sorry

Following an argument, apologies by everyone involved for their part in the dispute is the best way to move on. It's also important to say sorry if hurtful things were said in the heat of the moment. It can be difficult to take responsibility for an argument, but apologizing shows that a person can admit when they are wrong, and helps the other person feel valued. It also helps an individual to recognize what is important—valuing a relationship over holding a grudge.